

PHASE 2 · WEB DEVELOPMENT COURSE

Introduction to CSS3 & Styling Basics

HTML gave your pages structure. CSS is where they start to look like something.

inline/internal/external

selector-property-value

HEX/RGB/HSL

typography

Phase 1 (HTML) is complete — this is the first lecture of Phase 2 (CSS).

[Roadmap](#)

Today's Roadmap

- 01 What is CSS, and why does HTML need it?
- 02 Three ways to add CSS: inline, internal, external
- 03 CSS syntax & anatomy — selector, property, value
- 04 A quick primer on selectors: element, class, id
- 05 Color formats: HEX, RGB, HSL
- 06 Typography: font-family, font-size, line-height, text-align

[The big picture](#)

What Is CSS, and Why Do We Need It?

CSS stands for Cascading Style Sheets. If HTML is the skeleton of a page — headings, paragraphs, forms — CSS is everything about how it looks: colors, fonts, spacing, layout.

HTML = structure & content. **CSS** = presentation. Same HTML, completely different look, just by changing the CSS.

without CSS

My Blog

Welcome to my site. This is a paragraph of plain, unstyled text with no color or spacing choices.

with CSS

My Blog

Welcome to my site — styled with color, a nicer typeface, spacing, and centered text.

Adding CSS

Three Ways to Add CSS to a Page

Inline

```
style="..."
```

Written directly on one HTML tag.

Internal

```
<style>...</style>
```

Written inside <head>, affects the whole page.

External

```
<link rel="stylesheet">
```

A separate .css file, linked in — reusable across pages.

Way 1 of 3

Inline CSS — the style Attribute

Written directly inside a tag's `style` attribute. Applies to that one element only.

DOWNSIDE

Mixes content and style together, isn't reusable, and gets messy fast on a real page. Fine for a quick test — avoid it for real projects.

```
<p style="color: #D98324;  
  font-size: 20px;">  
  Hello, world!  
</p>
```

preview

Hello, world!

Way 2 of 3

Internal CSS — the `<style>` Tag

`<style>` goes inside `<head>`. Every rule inside it can target any element on that one page.

GOOD FOR

One-page sites, quick demos, or styles that are genuinely unique to a single page.

```
<head>
  <style>
    p {
      color: #D98324;
      font-size: 20px;
    }
  </style>
</head>
```

preview

Hello, world!

Way 3 of 3

External CSS — a Separate .css File

A whole separate file (e.g. style.css), connected with a `<link>` tag. The industry-standard way to write CSS.

WHY IT'S THE BEST PRACTICE

One file can style every page on your site. HTML stays clean and readable, and the browser can cache the CSS file separately.

```
<!-- in index.html -->
<head>
  <link rel="stylesheet"
        href="style.css">
</head>

/* in style.css */
p { color: #D98324; }
```

Quick reference

Which One Should You Use?

Method	Reusable?	Best for
Inline	No — one element only	A one-off quick test or override
Internal	Within that page only	A single-page site or demo
External	Yes — across every page	Real projects — this is the default choice

From here on, **we'll write CSS as if it's in an external file** — that's what you'll use in real projects.

Reading CSS

CSS Syntax & Anatomy

Every CSS rule has the same shape:

```
p { color: red; }
```

Selector

Which element(s) to style

Property

Which visual aspect to change

Value

What to set that property to

TWO MORE TERMS

color: red; alone is a declaration. Everything inside the { } braces together is the declaration block.

Reading CSS

A Quick Primer on Selectors

Element

```
p { }
```

Targets every <p> tag on the page.

```
<p>Hi</p>
```

Class

```
.highlight { }
```

Targets every tag with class="highlight" — reusable on many tags.

```
<p class="highlight">Hi</p>
```

ID

```
#header { }
```

Targets the one tag with id="header" — an ID must be unique on the page.

```
<div id="header">Hi</div>
```

[Color formats](#)

HEX — #RRGGBB

A hex code packs Red, Green, and Blue into one 6-digit code — two digits per channel, each from 00 (none) to FF (full).

- #000000 = black, #FFFFFF = white
- The most common format — used everywhere, including design tools like Figma and Canva



#D98324

```
p {  
  color: #D98324;  
}
```

Color formats

RGB — `rgb(red, green, blue)`

The same idea as HEX, but written as plain numbers from 0 to 255 for each channel — easier to read at a glance.

- `rgb(0, 0, 0)` = black, `rgb(255, 255, 255)` = white
- `rgba()` adds a 4th value (0 to 1) for transparency, e.g. `rgba(217, 131, 36, 0.5)`



`rgb(217, 131, 36)`

```
p {  
  color: rgb(217, 131, 36);  
}
```

Color formats

HSL — hsl(hue, saturation, lightness)

- Hue: position on a 0–360° color wheel (0=red, 120=green, 240=blue)
- Saturation: how intense the color is (0% = gray, 100% = full color)
- Lightness: how light or dark (0% = black, 100% = white)

WHY IT'S HANDY

Want the same color, just lighter or darker? Just change the lightness number — no need to recalculate a whole new hex code.

```
p {  
  color: hsl(32, 73%, 50%);  
}
```



hsl(32, 73%, 50%)

[Color formats](#)

Same Color, Three Ways

It's still the same orange, whichever notation you use:



HEX: `#D98324`

RGB: `rgb(217, 131, 36)`

HSL: `hsl(32, 73%, 50%)`

In real projects, pick whichever reads clearest to you — HEX is the most common default.

Typography

font-family — Choosing a Typeface

font-family sets the typeface. Always list a few options (a "font stack") ending in a generic family — in case the browser can't load your first choice.

```
p {  
  font-family: "Poppins",  
    Arial, sans-serif;  
}
```

preview — same text, different fonts

The quick fox

Georgia (serif)

The quick fox

Calibri (sans-serif)

The quick fox

Courier New (monospace)

Typography

font-size & line-height

font-size sets how big the text is (px, em, rem, %).

line-height sets the vertical space between lines — too tight feels cramped, too loose feels disconnected. 1.4–1.6 is a comfortable range for paragraphs.

```
p {  
  font-size: 16px;  
  line-height: 1.6;  
}
```

```
line-height: 1.0 (cramped)
```

Good design is as little design as possible.
Less, but better, because it concentrates
on the essential aspects.

```
line-height: 1.6 (comfortable)
```

Good design is as little design as possible.
Less, but better, because it concentrates
on the essential aspects.

text-align

text-align controls the horizontal alignment of text inside its container: left, center, right, or justify.

```
text-align: left
```

Styled text

```
text-align: center
```

Styled text

```
text-align: right
```

Styled text

```
h1 {  
  text-align: center;  
}
```

[Live demo](#)

Putting It All Together

```
/* style.css */
h1 {
  color: #D98324;
  font-family: Georgia, serif;
  text-align: center;
}

p {
  color: hsl(220, 10%, 25%);
  font-size: 16px;
  line-height: 1.6;
  text-align: center;
}
```

preview

Welcome

This paragraph uses an HSL color, a comfortable line-height, and centered text — all from one external stylesheet.

[Wrap-up](#)

Recap

You now know:

- What CSS is, and why HTML needs it
- Three ways to add CSS — and why external is the real-world default
- CSS anatomy: selector { property: value; }
- Element, class, and ID selectors
- Color formats: HEX, RGB, HSL — same colors, different notation
- Typography: font-family, font-size, line-height, text-align